Picky eaters are very selective about what they eat. They have a fear of new foods called "food neophobia", which is generally defined as the reluctance to eat, or even taste new foods. Children with neophobia often reject many 'new' foods.

3.1.4 Tips for feeding Picky or Fussy eaters

Get them involved
Children are more likely to try foods when they feel a sense of ownership. Include them in meal planning, grocery shopping and food preparation
Be Creative
Serve vegetables as finger foods with dips Use cookie cutters to cut fruits and vegetables into fun shapes Serve traditional meals out of order (for example, breakfast can be served for dinner)
Enhance Favorite Recipes
Blend, slice or shred vegetables into soups, pancakes, muffins or dosai Serve fruit with yoghurt or ice cream
Be a Role Model and Share
Be a role model to children by eating healthy foods yourself. Children may need multiple exposures to new food before they accept it, so do continue offering foods that a child initially rejects
Respect and relax
Children tend to eat sporadically. They have small stomachs and so tend to fill up fast and become hungry again soon after eating. Focus on the child's overall weekly intake of food and nutrients rather than on daily consumption

3.1.5 Nutrition related problems in pre-school children

Malnutrition is harmful in children as it retards their physical growth and may cause mental disabilities. Deficiency of calorie and proteins may trigger a wide range of pathological conditions in the children. Protein Energy Malnutrition (PEM) is the most common nutritional disorder among children. About 1-2 percent of preschool children suffer from protein energy malnutrition like Kwashiorkor and Marasmus. This is the reason why parents should insist that children drink milk; eat pulses and other sources of proteins.

PEM can affect all age groups but it is more frequent among infants and young children whose rapid growth increases nutritional requirement

Marasmus

- The term marasmus is derived from the Greek work marasmus, which means **withering or wasting**
- Marasmus is a form of severe protein-energy malnutrition characterized by energy deficiency and emaciation.
- Marasmus usually develops between the ages of six months and one year in children who have been weaned from breast milk or who suffer from weakening conditions like chronic diarrhoea.
- marasmus is characterized by stunted growth and wasting of muscle and tissue
- A typical case of marasmus can be described as **bonny cage** having nothing but "skin and bones"

Causes of Marasmus

- Seen most commonly in the first year of life due to lack of breast feeding and the use of dilute animal milk.
- Poverty or famine and diarrhoea are the usual precipitating factors

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